

7 Careers in OpenSolaris

Accumulating knowledge to quench your thirst of curiosity can be a regarding experience, but eventually everyone gets hungry. You may get great open source software for free, but a good meal still costs real money and at the end of the day we all have bills to pay. In this chapter, we would like to suggest some ways through which you can contribute to open source and build a career out of open source development. This chapter is specially relevant to high school and college students who are interested in making a career in IT world and who can use open source projects as learn many things by doing it rather than just reading about it!

7.1 Career as a Developer

At first, lets list out what are some of the skills employers would look for in a candidate for a software engineering role which involves programming or software design:

- Good knowledge of programming
- Good understanding of software engineering practices
- Ability to work in teams
- And with teams now going multinational, ability to work with people of different nationality and culture

Now lets examine how contributing to open source builds all these skills in you. The process of open source development involves lots of things. If you decide to contribute code to any popular existing open source project, or start a project of your own (which a sizable number of people should use of course!), you will have to go through a strong peer review of your code. You do not have to be a native speaker of C or C++ to be a open source developer, but you will need to have a flair for writing good quality code for it to get it added to the project. This means that you need to have good understanding of not only the syntax of a language, but also a grip on good programming practices and coding style. So when your resume says that you have contributed to a major open source project, the employers can be confident that you have good programming skills as well as good understanding of software engineering practices.

Usually, many contributors participate in a open source project and contributing to involves very strong teamwork. Many people work together to bring out a complete open source product. So in this process, you get